

# **PERCEPTION OF GEN Z TOWARDS SUSTAINABLE CONSUMPTION AND LIFESTYLE CHOICES IN INDIA**

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## **ABSTRACT**

Sustainable development is an issue of global significance, urging conscious decisions and lifestyle changes from each individual, especially from younger generations. Gen Z as one of the most active and well-informed generation plays an indispensable part in forging a sustainable future for the years to come. The present research paper endeavors to investigate Gen Z perception towards sustainable consumption and life style practice in India with an objective to explore their awareness level, attitude and behavior patterns in relation to sustainability and responsible consumption. “Primary data has been collected through a structured questionnaire of five points scale (Likert Scale)”. The survey was conducted by the investigator through Google forms, collecting response from Gen Z of various age groups. The data was analyzed in order to bring out meaningful and useful insights from the responses. It is proved by the results that the majority of Gen Z respondents hold positive attitude toward living a sustainable life, as well as have the knowledge of the sustainable development. Many people from young generations stated willingness for reduction of waste and usage of green products, and supportive towards green practice in their life. Internet platforms, educational institutes and government efforts can contribute a lot for promoting awareness as well as behavior regarding the sustainable development. In conclusion, Gen Z can do a lot for the sustainability development through lifestyle modification and consumer practice; moreover, the policy makers, educationists and researchers need to look forward to increase the awareness programs for young people and its proper implementation with efficient government policies and technology usage to enhance sustainable development for the nation and nation at global level.

**Keywords: Gen Z Perception, Sustainable Lifestyle, Green consumption, Youth Behavior, Environmental Sustainability, India**

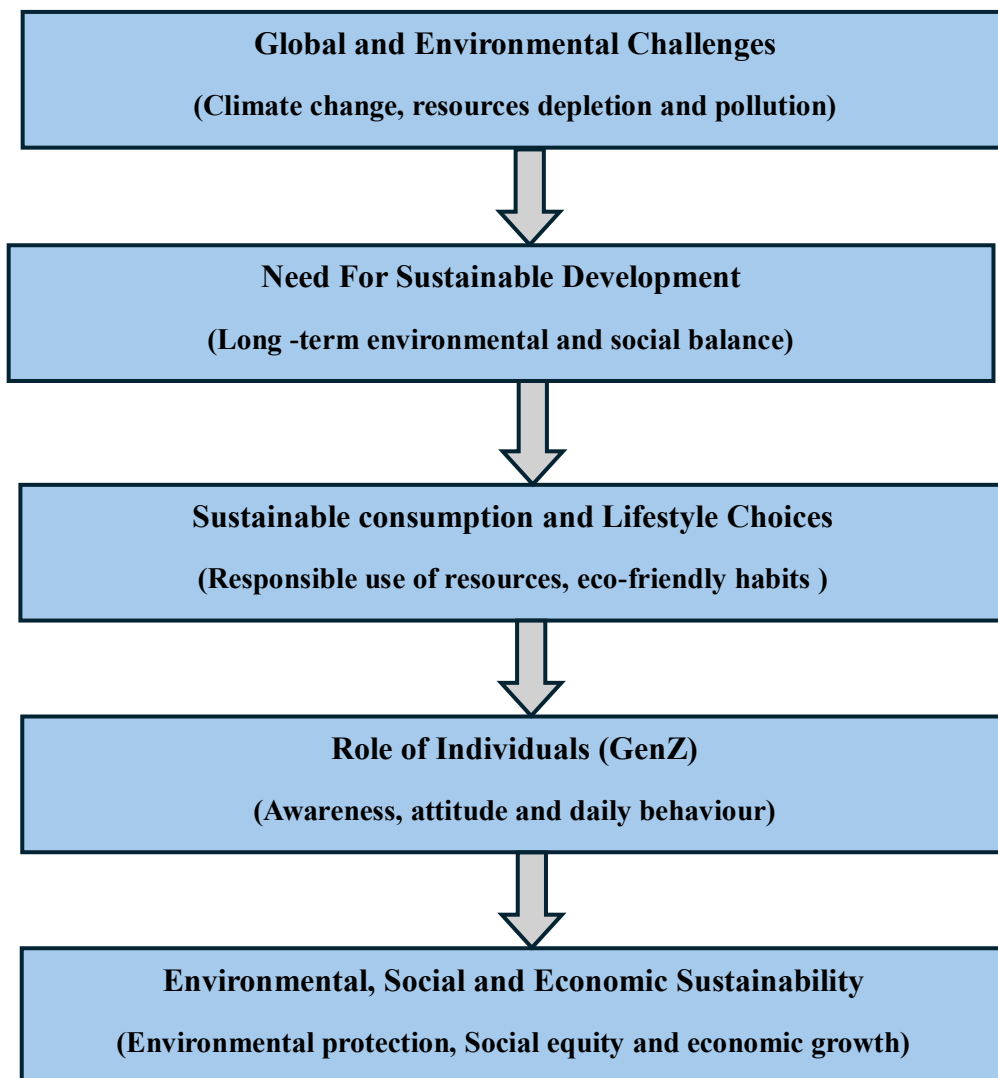
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## **INTRODUCTION**

In recent years sustainable development has taken center stage as an important development concept and policy challenge as concerns about the environment, climate change, and natural resource depletion are growing worldwide. Sustainable development has been accepted by governments as a policy imperative and demands changes not only at the macro- policy level but also in individual behavior and lifestyle choices. Consumption choices particularly by the young generations have been recognized to play an instrumental role in determining environmental and social impacts and therefore Sustainable Consumption and lifestyle choices have now become major themes of debate within the sustainable development discourse. “Gen Z” commonly defined as born between “1997-2014” is the first generation having grown up with an overwhelming exposure to digital technologies, social networking and global information flows. “Gen Z” relative to the older generations, is also believed to know more about ‘environment issues like protection of environment, global warming, sustainability and etc.’

**Fig1:- Conceptual Overview Of Sustainable Consumption and Lifestyle Choices**



Source : Created by the Researcher

The “**fig. 1**” below conceptually shows the interconnections between global environmental problems and SDGs. The figure also emphasizes on the contribution of sustainable consumption and lifestyle of Gen Z in attaining environmental, social and economic sustainability.

In the context of India, ever-increasing pace of urbanization, population growth and changing lifestyles are exerting immense pressure on natural resources. Various sustainable development policies, schemes and campaigns have been introduced to make an attempt to promote sustainable consumption. However, in achieving the aim of sustainable development, the crucial elements for a successful progress are the understanding and behavioural change in the public and citizens of a country. Considering the above importance, it becomes very significant to analyze the perception of Gen Z about sustainable consumption and lifestyle. In this way, we can assess the participation and awareness of youth generation (Gen Z) in achieving sustainable development goals. This paper aims at analyzing the perception of Gen Z about sustainable consumption and lifestyle.

## **The study is based on 5 key Concepts**

### **1. Sustainable Literacy**

“A person’s level of knowledge and awareness of green products and sustainable consumption behavior, including eco-label recognition, awareness of benefits, and product impact on the environment and human health, is known as sustainable literacy.” People are more inclined to make thoughtful purchases as a result of this insight. However, real sustainable purchasing behavior does not always follow from awareness about sustainable items and processes.

### **2. Social Influence**

The impact of friends, family, and society on people’s opinions and purchasing behavior has been widely addressed as social influence. As such, it has also been widely considered as an important determinant of sustainable consumption. This becomes particularly salient in younger consumers, as a pro-environmental stance can be facilitated by observing other people behaving in accordance to this concept. Social approval from and alignment with peers may also encourage purchase of sustainable products.

### **3. Sustainable Purchasing Attitude**

Sustainable purchasing attitude can be understood as individuals' evaluation of the buying behavior towards eco-friendly product. An individual with sustainable purchasing attitude toward green product possesses a positive mindset regarding purchasing eco-friendly product, and will likely develop belief toward that product "will have positive impact toward the environment" and health. The power of the purchasing purpose to buy "eco-friendly product" will depend on the attitude towards such product.

### **4. Sustainable Purchasing Behavior**

The term "sustainable purchasing behavior" describes consumers' choices of "environmentally-friendly products" and eco-shopping, such as "natural food products," "products with recycled packaging," or "products with low environmental damage effect. This reflects the practice of the "Sustainable Purchasing Attitude" by consumer. This behavior has a long-term perspective of impacting the environment more positively, hence lead to overall sustainable living.

### **5. Sustainable Lifestyle**

Sustainable lifestyle refers to the lifestyle practices toward minimize impact on the environment; it involves such practice as the way people live daily through the aspect of their consumption, which will likely consist of reduce waste, energy conservation and purchase of eco-friendly product. Once sustained purchasing behavior exists in long term as habitual action in the consumers' behavior, it will eventually form a sustainable lifestyle in the individuals.

## **Research objectives**

The following goals have been established for the study:

- To determine the perception of GenZ towards Sustainable Purchase Behaviour
- To determine the perception of GenZ towards sustainable lifestyle
- To analyse previous literature related to Sustainable Behaviour of GenZ
- To make a theoretical Framework (model) based on Sustainable Behaviour of GenZ

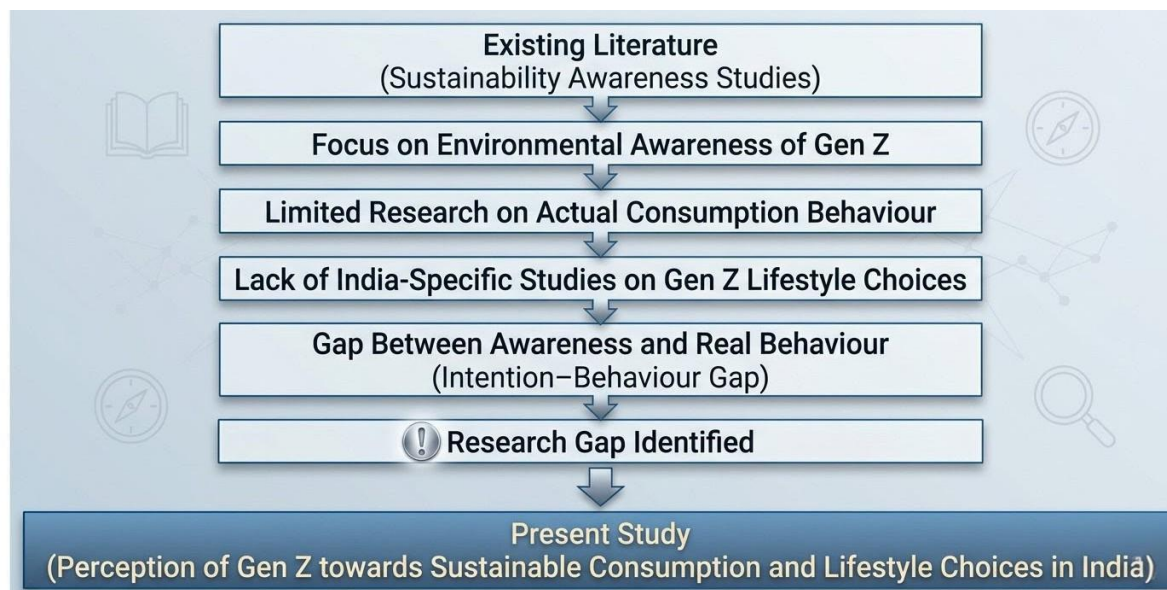
## **Research Gap**

Past literature explored sustainable development, consumption, and behavior under various perspectives of governmental initiative, responsibility of business and behavior of consumer. Some researches were also carried out in India; There is still scope for more research on Generation Z, especially in relation to sustainable consumption and lifestyle choices. Especially the linkages of various factors namely sustainable literacy, influence from social element, sustainable purchase attitude, and sustainable purchase behavior with sustainable lifestyle have received less attention.

In most cases of the studies, a separate concern of purchase towards sustainable consumption was discussed whereas; these factors have not been sufficiently discussed when taken as a whole in relation to sustainable lifestyle in the Gen Z-focused framework.

Hence, this study attempts to address the research gap on the perception of Gen Z consumers towards sustainable consuming lifestyle through an empirical study based on primary data collected from respondents in Delhi NCR, so as to provide useful insights on the basis of empirical evidence and young focus in the future by researchers, awareness programs, policy makers and different campaigns towards sustainable consumption habits.

**Fig2: Research Gap of the Study**



**Source: Self Developed by Researcher**

## **LITERATURE REVIEW**

Authors offers a theoretical background to explain consumers' behavioral responses, the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB). TPB posits that three factors (attitude, subjective norms, and perceive behavioral control) jointly account for variation in behavior. These concepts, in the area of sustainable consumption, contribute to the understanding why some consumers will shape a positive attitude towards an environmentally responsible products/ practices and behaviors. The present study will attempt to examine the determinants of sustainable consumption behavior by adapting the original theory as the theoretical support instead of direct hypothesis testing the original TPB theory. Based on previous researches, the theory has been extended and new variables have been explored in this study by using Sustainable Literacy, Social Influence to construct antecedents of Sustainable Purchase Attitude which subsequently led to Sustainable Purchase Behavior and Sustainable Lifestyle. Sustainable Literacy will refer to consumer' understanding and awareness toward the sustainable consumptions, while Social Influence refers to the role of others towards the Sustainable Purchase Attitude. (Ajzen1991)

Authors studies the factors affecting green purchase behavior among consumers. They found that environmental concerns and ethical responsibility impact the sustainable buying decisions. “The researchers observed that when consumers feel morally committed towards the protection of the environment then they emphasized that intentions may not always translate into actions, but they did favor eco-friendly goods. They showed that many consumers expressed their concerns towards the environmental protection, but failed to change their purchase behavior due to situational constraints. This study is significant as it presents both motivational and practical factors of the green buying behavior. It showed that awareness towards the environment is not only enough, along with the awareness availability and purchase price are also important factor and relevant in developing countries like India. (Joshi & Rahman2015).

The Effects of EA and customer perception efficacy on “green buying intent” has been examined by authors. It showed that people are quite concerned about purchasing “eco-friendly goods.” when they feel that the individual effort towards buying sustainable products lead to some positive change towards the environmental protection. It has been found that confidence of consumers towards their behavior impact greatly over their purchase decision related to sustainable consumption. If the consumers do not have confidence over the individual effort towards environment, the behavior cannot be expected. It also indicated the importance of the effective communication with the consumers that would make them feel more effective and confident. These are important as the habit of sustainable buying is being formed among young consumers. (Kumar& Ghodeswar2015).

Authors have explored Sustainable consumption behavior among Indian youth. From this study it was revealed that even though Indian young consumers hold Positivity toward the preservation of the environment and sustainable products, but the actual purchase behavior of young consumers for the sustainable product is quite low. Higher prices and non-availability of eco-friendly products were considered as the major reason for this. Thus, it is realized that consumers are motivated with the attitude towards the environment but deterred by economic and practical concerns. It highlighted the unexpected between consumers' purpose and their purchasing habits in relation to India. This study is highly relevant to the current GenZ consumer's study. (Sharma &Jha2017).

Authors investigated how environmental concerned impacts the green purchase intention. Their findings revealed that, the individuals holding a significant care for the environment are more likely to cultivate an optimistic mindset and the purpose to invest in ecologically beneficial goods, but the study also discovered that the intention did not result in the actual purchase behavior because of things like time limits, convenience, cost considerations, and lifestyle limitations. This finding suggested that even the environmentally conscious individuals may not always be seen adopting green purchase behavior due to the behavioral and situational factors which must be taken into account jointly in the behavior of the young consumers in urban setting. (Paul et al.2016).

Authors examined sustainable behavior among young consumers of Generation Z. It was found that the Generation Z is highly aware and eager to support green products and brands, but they are influenced by many factors such as affordability, authenticity, quality etc. The study highlighted that trust played a very important role in Green Marketing. Even if they had good intention to support green brand, they had to lose trust if green claim is doubted. Awareness needs to be supported by communication about products through transparency and credible channels. These finding provided a good insight about young Indian consumer and support studying both awareness and behavior. (Verma & Chandra 2018).

This study indicated that social influence and peer behavior significantly impacted youngsters' consumption patterns towards sustainable products. It suggested that young consumers rely greatly upon peer influence in their buying decisions. Individuals will be prone to adapt to green behavior if the same is socially accepted or if the members of their social circle praise for the particular behavior. This research clearly reflected the importance of social approval and peer pressure on establishing sustainable lifestyle among young consumers. It also pointed out that social campaigns could be launched to increase responsible consumption behaviors among youth. This aspect seems to be relevant in the context of Generation Z who are highly connected to social media. Their behavior tends to be shaped by trends, influence from social circles and social comparison, so it is not surprising that the role of social influence emerges as one of the important determinants of their sustainable consumption behavior. (Biswas &Roy2015).

Authors discussed discrepancy between attitude towards environment and purchasing behavior. They showed that most of the consumers held positive attitude toward the env. However, they don't "consistently buy green products." It concluded that the disparity was caused by things like "high price, lack of information, convenience," etc. The study indicated that barriers to purchase would always play an external role over consumer decision making processes and positive intention is never enough to bring up sustainable behavior of individuals. Businesses and policymakers need to decrease external barriers and in relation of younger consumers it should be the center. (Young et al.2010).

The study by (Kumar, Prakash and Kumar 2021) focused on the environmentally responsible purchase intention of Indian consumers, considering eco-friendly apparel. The results concluded that consumers had favorable attitudes toward green apparel and that subjective norms, perceived behavioral control, and environmental consciousness positively influenced their purchase intention. The study also revealed the significance of customer education on environmentally friendly goods and encourages sustainable buying habits.

In their research, (Uddin & Khan 2016) investigated green purchasing behaviour among Indian young people. This study indicates that environmental attitude, environmental awareness, environmental involvement, perceived effectiveness of environmental behaviour were the key attributes that impact green purchasing behavior. One crucial observation made in this study was a value-action gap; that awareness and attitudes towards the environment do not necessarily translate into action (i.e. green buying intent) among young Indian consumers, implying that other attributes may hinder them from translating their environmental concerns into action.

The study emphasizes that young customers in developing nations like India are becoming increasingly environmentally conscious but lack support from institutions to continue sustainable lifestyles. The research concluded that raising awareness alone is not enough to encourage such lifestyles and that there is a need for government and institutional support. The study also suggests that while Gen Z is showing interest in sustainability they still face obstacles that prevent them from taking necessary actions, hence Their behaviors and their consciousness are not in sync. (Kumar et al. 2017)

A study conducted by (Gupta and Acharya 2019) researched green consumption of young Indian consumers where all personal factors, social and environmental issues do an important role to contribute Green consumption. Also found that young consumers take decision regarding making green consumption on different points; it does not look like to depend only on green awareness for green consumption.

The study explored green consumption behavior among Gen Z consumers in Indian cities, finding that social influences, education, and environmental awareness significantly impact purchasing decisions toward green products. Peers, family, and media played important roles in shaping consumer choices, and younger, more educated respondents were more likely to adopt eco-friendly practices. However, barriers like price and availability remained significant factors,

clearly illustrating the multitude of issues that influence Gen Z's perception toward sustainability. (Jyothi & Mohan 2025)

(Meet, Kundu and Ahluwalia 2024) investigated variables affecting green purchase intention of Gen Z consumers in India. The results found that green price, green advertisement and green packaging positively affected the purchase intention but greenwashing has negative affect. Besides, the study indicated socio-demographic variable such as gender, education and income are affecting Gen Z green purchase intention. Thus, practical and marketing determinants is not only one thing that shape the Gen Z green buying.

The researchers found that consumer faith in responsible products and green claims is a primary determinant of behavior, and a lack of it can be a deterrent. The research also emphasizes the need for transparent communication with credible green claims, which is notably important for Gen Z who tend to be critical of greenwashing. (Chen & Chang 2013)

The author explained that sustainable consumption encompasses not only buying "green products" but reducing overall consumption levels and adopting certain life styles, thereby promoting long term behavior change. This concept is critical for Gen Z as their consumption habits significantly impact sustainability as a whole, thus broadening the scope of sustainable consumption to lifestyle changes rather than consumption. (Peattie 2010)

The authors have identified Social and psychological aspects such as habits and lack of motivation that limit behavioral changes towards sustainability, despite consumers being aware of environmental issues and believing such actions to be right. The authors conclude that while awareness may have increased but these social barriers must be taken into consideration to facilitate behavioral change. (Gifford & Nilsson 2014)

Author argued that habitual behavior and lifestyle are extremely significant for sustainable consumption. According to the author, an individual's daily habits, routines are critical in determining the person's actual consumption behavior although the individual is concerned about environmental problems. He believed that a long-term shift in behavior is needed for sustainability. The researcher points out that consumption for sustainability is a habitual lifestyle, not an event. It is also found that social norms and personal values also affect consumption behavior. It is especially important in relation to Gen Z that the individuals' daily behavior and lifestyle will lead to considerable impacts toward environment. These results propose for the necessity to encourage sustained behavior in younger consumers. (Thøgersen 2010)

**Fig 3: Summary of Major Studies**

| <b>Authors &amp; Year</b>          | <b>Focus of Study</b>                      | <b>Key Findings</b>                                                              | <b>Relevance to Present Study</b>                                     |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>(Ajzen1991)</b>                 | <b>Theory of planned behaviour</b>         | <b>Behaviour depends on attitude social norms, and perceived control</b>         | <b>Helps explain Gen Z decision-making in sustainable consumption</b> |
| <b>(Joshi &amp; Rahman2015)</b>    | <b>Green Purchase Behaviour</b>            | <b>Environmental concern influences intention but not always action</b>          | <b>Shows intention-behaviour gap</b>                                  |
| <b>(Kumar &amp; Ghodeswar2015)</b> | <b>Consumer Effectiveness</b>              | <b>Belief in personal impact influences green behaviour</b>                      | <b>Explains role of perception in Sustainability</b>                  |
| <b>(Sharma &amp; Jha 2017)</b>     | <b>Youth Sustainable Behaviour</b>         | <b>Positive attitude but low actual purchase due to price &amp; availability</b> | <b>Highlights practical barriers in India</b>                         |
| <b>(Paul et al.2016)</b>           | <b>Environmental concern and Behaviour</b> | <b>Concern affects intention but lifestyle constraints affect action</b>         | <b>Shows real – time Limitations</b>                                  |
| <b>(Biswas &amp; Roy2015)</b>      | <b>Social Influence</b>                    | <b>Peer pressure &amp; social norms affect Sustainable choices</b>               | <b>Important for Gen Z behaviour</b>                                  |

The literature shows that Generation Z is aware of sustainability, but price, convenience, and social influence”. Particularly in the Indian culture, there’s a discrepancy within intended and actual actions.

(Kim & Stepchenkova, 2020) These works suggest sustainable literacy encompasses the consumer’s awareness and knowledge of environment friendly products and practices. It includes consumers’ awareness on eco labels, environment impact, benefit on buying green products. It is suggested that higher literacy levels may lead to positive sustainable product attitude, yet it cannot determine actual purchasing behaviour. Therefore, it should be accompanied by other factors to make it effective for buying actions.

(Lee,2008) The influence of the “social factor on consumer attitude and behaviour”. Consumers are guided by peer, friends, and social network in consuming choices. In the context of

sustainable consumption, social influence determines consumers to abide by social norms and expectation of consuming eco-friendly products in the community, group and association, thus influencing their attitudes toward the sustainable products.

(Nguyen et al., 2016; Ajzen, 1991) These studies state attitude towards sustainable buying is a determinant for actual purchasing behavior in the sustainability context. Ajzen's TPB explains positive attitude to a behavior will lead to more likelihood to performing behavior. When a consumer thinks that buying a green product can contribute to the welfare of the environment and their well-being they can form a positive attitude to the green product, hence influence consumer intention to obtain the "green products".

(Dangelico & Pontrandolfo, 2010) The research describes sustainable purchase behavior as a purchase decision and action that takes environmental criteria into account when making decisions concerning purchasing products. It encompasses a consumption that favors organic and recyclable products and also includes consumption pattern that minimize environmental impact in making a purchase. Sustainable purchase behavior means a consumer is performing the decision and intention based on their attitude. Thus, sustainable purchase behavior contributes to the protection of environment.

(Jackson, 2009; Lubowiecki-Vikuk et al., 2021) This describes sustainable lifestyle as an integrated pattern of life through adopting various habits and actions toward sustainability in a long-term basis. It covers the adoption of practices such as waste minimization, energy conservation, and eco-friendly consumption pattern that eventually contribute to an environmentally sustainable lifestyle.

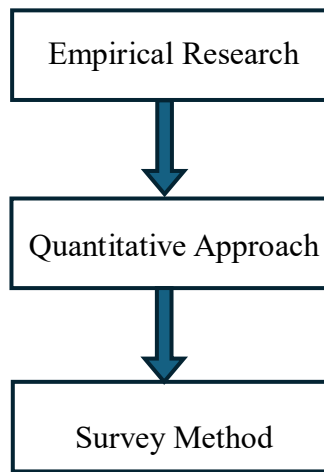
In summary, the studies surveyed reflect that there are various factors that affect the consumption choices toward sustainability among young consumers and include the variables like sustainable awareness, social influence, attitude, price, convenience, availability, and trust. While there were findings indicating the strong positive relationship between sustainable awareness, favorable attitudes and sustainable consumption behavior but at the same time, the existence of positive attitudes can sometimes does not predict sustainable buying behavior in young consumers. Likewise, social factor and external factors might have strong impact on young consumers decision making. Hence it is evident that single factor does not determine a sustainable consumption behavior and the integrated approach needs to be examined in while analyzing the sustainable lifestyle of Gen Z.

## **RESEARCH METHODOLOGY**

### **Research Design**

The current research adopted an empirical research design because it makes use of first hand collected data from respondents. This method of study was employed as the current research aims to get the perception of “Generation Z” about the “sustainable consumption” and lifestyle pattern in India. Empirical research helps us to acquire in-depth and real-life information on attitude and awareness of the respondents on chosen topic.

**Fig.4: Research Design**



Source: Self Developed by Researcher

### **Nature of the study**

In terms of approach, this is quantitative as it has gathered figures via the structured questionnaire. With quantitative approach objective conclusion can be drawn through the result in statistics.

### **Population of the study**

The study's sample is made of GenZ “individuals” in India. Most of the population in this range will fall into the age bracket of 14-28 years old. The age was chosen because Generation Z is thought to be most receptive of and aware of topics related to sustainability.

### **Location of the Study**

All the respondents surveyed in the study were based in Delhi NCR. Delhi NCR was chosen for the survey due to the ready availability of Gen Z respondents, particularly college and school students. Delhi NCR provides a well-suited environment for observing sustainable consumption

and lifestyle choices among young consumers, and this was the main reason for choosing it for collecting primary data from Gen Z respondents for the present study.

### **Sample size & sampling Technique**

The number of total respondents that was participate in the research is 412. The sampling that have been used is purposive sampling. This is because the research was specifically conducted on Generation Z respondent, where the purposive sampling technique is very suitable to be used, as it enables the researcher to pick the participants that fit in to the criteria required. Besides, time and resources are also a reason in selecting the technique used.

**Fig. 5: sampling Details of the study**

| <b>Elements</b>           | <b>Description</b>        |
|---------------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>Population</b>         | <b>Generation Z</b>       |
| <b>Sample Size</b>        | <b>412 respondents</b>    |
| <b>Sampling Technique</b> | <b>Purposive Sampling</b> |
| <b>Location</b>           | <b>Delhi(NCR)</b>         |

Source : Self-Developed by the Researcher

### **Data collection method**

Data has been gathered through primary data collection and the research was conducted by a structured questionnaire design using Google Forms which has been distributed on social media like WhatsApp, Instagram to the Gen Z respondents. A “5-point Likert scale” has been used in the questionnaire and asked to provide their agreement from

- Strongly Disagree
- Disagree
- Neutral
- Agree
- Strongly Agree

| Response Option   | Scale Value | Description                                          |
|-------------------|-------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Strongly Disagree | 1           | Respondent completely disagrees with the statement   |
| Disagree          | 2           | Respondent disagrees with the statement              |
| Neutral           | 3           | Respondent is unsure or indifferent to the statement |
| Agree             | 4           | Respondent agrees with the statement                 |
| Strongly Agree    | 5           | Respondent completely agrees with the statement      |

**Fig6: Likert scale used in Questionnaire**

**Source: Self Developed by the Researcher**

### **Research Instrument**

The study used a self- created questionnaire as its research tool, consisting of 14 statements relating to sustainable consumption behaviour, life style, environmental concerns and responsible consumption, the question was prepared with simple language so as to make it clearly understood by everyone.

Before administering the questionnaire to obtain the final respondents' data, it was checked by the lecturer to ensure that the statements were appropriate to the research topic and understandable to the respondents. Modifications were carried out according to the recommendations before the actual questionnaires were distributed.

### **Data Analysis Tools**

Software called the (SPSS) was utilized to examine information gathered for this study. Various Analytical approach like “significant positive relationship” was performed using SPSS and were applied to understand the perception of the Gen Z about sustainable lifestyle and consumption pattern in India. The findings of the same provided good insights for the objectives of the study.

### **Ethical Considerations**

The subjects were made to know that the data will be kept confidential, there will be no personal information required and it will be used only for academic purpose.

### **Limitation of the study**

The research is restricted to Generation Z respondents only and the sample size is restricted to 412 respondents which may not fully represent then tired population. The study’s self-reported data may contain personal bias. Given that data were collected by self-report, social desirability bias may have influenced responses. That is, individuals may have reported that they hold more

environmentally positive attitudes or engage in more environmentally beneficial actions than they actually feel or perform. This is recognized as a limitation of the study.

### **Chapter Summary**

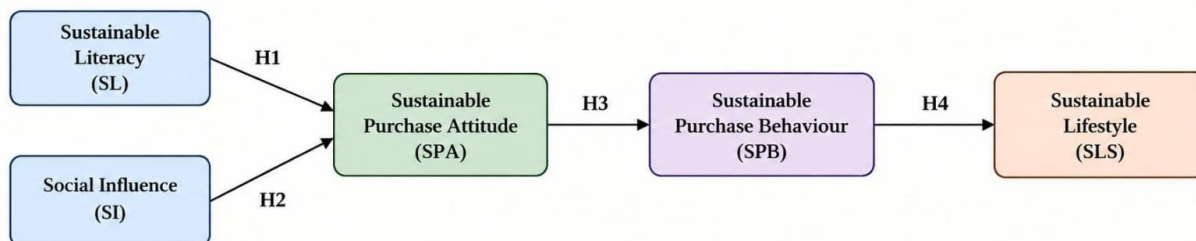
This lesson is divided in sections describing RD, DC procedure, sampling technique and “Research instrument” along with research tools employed for analysis of the data collected. The research methodology followed enables us to study in a structured manner, the perception of Generation Z about sustainable consumption and lifestyle options in India.

## **Theoretical Framework and Hypotheses**

This study is grounded in a theoretical approach which proposes associations among the main variables concerning sustainable consumption and lifestyle. Specifically, it postulates sustainable literacy and social influence as variables concerning sustainable purchase attitude, which is directly associated with sustainable purchase behaviour and the latter with sustainable lifestyle, whereas it takes the practical constraints of sustainability purchase behaviour on positive attitude into consideration.

**Fig 7: Theoretical Framework of the Study**

**Figure 7: Theoretical Framework**



**Notes:**

- H1: Sustainable Literacy (SL) is positively related to Sustainable Purchase Attitude (SPA).
- H2: Social Influence (SI) is positively related to Sustainable Purchase Attitude (SPA).
- H3: Sustainable Purchase Attitude (SPA) is positively related to Sustainable Purchase Behaviour (SPB).
- H4: Sustainable Purchase Behaviour (SPB) is positively related to Sustainable Lifestyle (SLS).

**Source:** created by the Researcher

**Note:** The adapted framework is based on the original framework informed by the Theory of Planned Behavior. This adapted framework does not empirically test all the constructs from the original TBP framework.

## **DATA ANALYSIS**

The acquired data was examined by using SPSS in order to test the reliability of all measurement items and test of associations among the variables. Descriptive analysis were performed in order to describe the respondents' answers whereas correlation analysis was performed in order to test relationship between the tested variables. The findings of the data analysis are as follows;

### **Reliability**

Reliability indicates the consistency and stability with which a measurement tool can repeatedly generate exact outcome under exact context. Reliability implies the degree to which the scale is not sensitive to chance errors and will yield the same outcome under the same context.

Reliability ensures that when the scale is used under the same conditions the results are not contradictory. It is an important tool in the research area because one has to maintain accuracy and trustworthiness of the findings. One of the popular approaches used to measure “reliability” is Cronbach’s Alpha. (C. R. Kothari, 2004)

### **Cronbach’s Alpha**

“Cronbach’s Alpha” is a statistical evaluate of internal continuity, and hence reliability of a set of scale items. It measures the degree of interrelatedness within the set of items, suggesting if a group of items measure the same conceptual domain. If a Cronbach’s Alpha is higher, it means that the reliability of measurement is better among a group of variables. This is most often used for testing the reliability of survey questionnaires and data sets in social science research. (Lee J. Cronbach, 1951)

The level of internal continuity of the “variables” can be ascertained by “Cronbach’s Alpha”. If “Cronbach’s Alpha” level’s  $\geq 0.7$  then the reliability of the scale is acceptable. Higher the level, the greater the consistency.

(Joseph F. Hair Jr. et al., 2010)

**Fig8: Reliability Analysis**

## Reliability Analysis

| Variable                       | No. of Items | Cronbach's Alpha |
|--------------------------------|--------------|------------------|
| Sustainable Literacy           | 3            | 0.849            |
| Social Influence               | 3            | 0.819            |
| Sustainable Purchase Attitude  | 3            | 0.833            |
| Sustainable Purchase Behaviour | 2            | 0.754            |
| Sustainable Lifestyle          | 3            | 0.770            |

Source: Created by Researcher using SPSS Software

In order to evaluate the uniformity within the dimension scale used in the survey, a “Cronbach’s Alpha reliability analysis” was performed. That’s shown in the table, all the constructs had the value greater than 0.7, which is accepted as a general rule of thumb to determine reliable measurement. The three scales, Sustainable Literacy (0.849), Social Influence (0.819), and Sustainable Purchase Attitude (0.833) have a high level of reliability. Although Sustainable Purchase Behaviour (0.754) and Sustainable Lifestyle (0.770) have values that are relatively lower than others, it is still within acceptable limit. It is thus inferred that the measuring instrument employed in this survey is reliable.

### **Kaiser-Meyer-Olkin (KMO) and Bartlett’s Test**

They are analytical indexes that verify the relevance of the data to Factorial Analysis. KMO test tests whether there is adequate data in order to detect structure; in general terms values close to 1 are adequate for factor analysis and it is commonly believed that any KMO above “0.6” is Reasonable. “Bartlett’s Test of Sphericity tests” whether the variables are complimentary with one another and if the “significance level is less than 0.05” variables are suitable for “factorial Analysis”

(Henry F. Kaiser, 1974; M. S. Bartlett, 1954)

**Fig 9: KMO & Bartlett's Test**

| <b>KMO and Bartlett's Test<sup>a</sup></b>            |                    |              |
|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|--------------|
| <b>Measure</b>                                        |                    | <b>Value</b> |
| Kaiser-Meyer-Olkin (KMO) Measure of Sampling Adequacy |                    | 0.953        |
| Bartlett's Test of Sphericity                         | Approx. Chi-Square | 3793.185     |
|                                                       | df                 | 91           |
|                                                       | Sig.               | .000         |

**Source:** Created by Researcher using SPSS Software

To determine whether the data were suitable for factorial analysis, the KMO assesment of sample adequacy and Bartlett's Test of Sphericity were used. As reported in the table, "KMO value' of 0.953 is shown, which is excellent and shows excellent sampling adequacy and it means that the data fits the structure detection very well. What's more, Bartlett's "Test of Sphericity" has a "chi-square value" of 3793.185 with 91 degree of freedom, and the sig. is 0.000 which is less than 0.05, showing that the variables are inter-correlated at a significant level and it fits to factor analysis. In summary, the data are applicable to be further analyzed with factor loading to test validity.

### **Validity**

The degree to which a device measures what it is supposed to measure is known as its validity. A measurement tool has validity when the results obtained actually measure the concept in question, and not influenced by irrelevant factors. A valid tool increases the trustworthiness and accuracy of findings, and in empirical study validity proves that the concepts being measured are actually represented by the variable used.(Joseph F. Hair Jr. et al., 2010)

### **Factor Loading**

Factor loading refers to the correlation between latent constructs that underlie observable variables. It indicates how strongly each item contributes to a particular factor. Higher factor loadings represent stronger relationships and better construct validity. A commonly accepted

threshold is 0.6 or above, which indicates that the variable significantly contributes to the factor and is considered acceptable for analysis. (Joseph F. Hair Jr. et al., 2010)

**Fig10: Factor Loading Table**

| Factor Loading Table               |           |                |
|------------------------------------|-----------|----------------|
| Factor                             | Item Code | Factor Loading |
| (1) Sustainable Literacy           | SL1       | 0.789          |
|                                    | SL2       | 0.744          |
|                                    | SL3       | 0.814          |
| (2) Social Influence               | SI1       | 0.796          |
|                                    | SI2       | 0.781          |
|                                    | SI3       | 0.798          |
| (3) Sustainable Purchase Attitude  | SPA1      | 0.788          |
|                                    | SPA2      | 0.818          |
|                                    | SPA3      | 0.693          |
| (4) Sustainable Purchase Behaviour | SPB1      | 0.724          |
|                                    | SPB2      | 0.705          |
| (5) Sustainable Lifestyle          | SL1       | 0.757          |
|                                    | SL2       | 0.794          |
|                                    | SL3       | 0.634          |

**Source:** Created by Researcher using SPSS Software

The loadings of all the items were greater than accepted guidelines of 0.60 therefore reflecting acceptable relationship between the items and their construct. However, the values obtained by factor loadings did not confirm that the five construct were empirically distinct entities, hence interpreted with reference to the overall factor loadings matrix.

### **Descriptive Statistics**

“Descriptive statistics is utilized as a collection of techniques in which the characteristics of a data set are summarized and represented in an easy-to-understand format, in which statistics such as, mean, median, mode, standard deviation and percentage are utilized”. This Statistics allows the interpretation of distribution, central point and dispersion of data set. The main aim of descriptive analysis is that the sample characteristics should be evident in a concise manner. No attempt is made to generalize beyond the data in this stage of analysis. (C. R. Kothari, 2004)

**Fig 11: Descriptive Statistics**

| Descriptive Statistics |      |                |            |
|------------------------|------|----------------|------------|
|                        | Mean | Std. Deviation | Analysis N |
| SL1                    | 4.07 | .873           | 412        |
| SL2                    | 4.13 | .917           | 412        |
| SL3                    | 4.27 | .867           | 412        |
| SI1                    | 4.02 | .970           | 412        |
| SI2                    | 4.03 | .997           | 412        |
| SI3                    | 4.20 | .948           | 412        |
| SPA1                   | 4.17 | .919           | 412        |
| SPA2                   | 4.13 | .898           | 412        |
| SPA3                   | 4.10 | .904           | 412        |
| SPB1                   | 4.04 | .919           | 412        |
| SPB2                   | 3.91 | .972           | 412        |
| SL1                    | 4.10 | .944           | 412        |
| SL2                    | 4.18 | .799           | 412        |
| SL3                    | 4.21 | .873           | 412        |

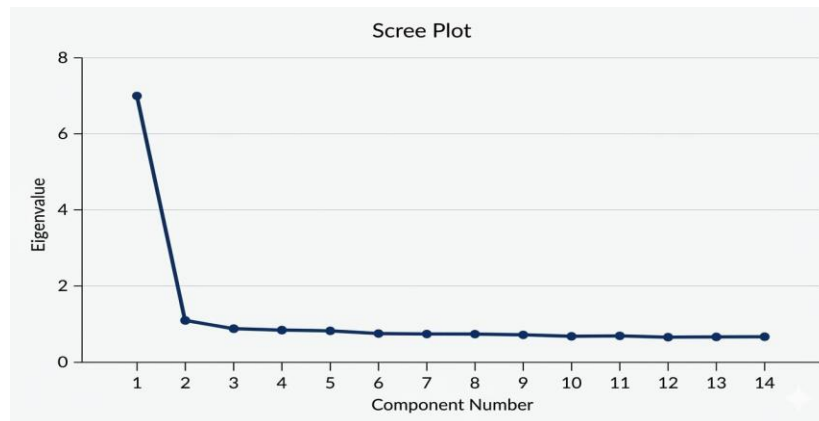
**Source:** Created by Researcher using SPSS Software

This set of descriptive statistics reveals quite well of the attitude of the respondents toward sustainable consumption and lifestyle. The means values for all of the variables range from 3.91 to 4.27, meaning that the respondents have quite high agreement with each item. Sustainable Literacy (SL) shows fairly high means value. Thus, mean value suggest a positive response on SL. Similar to this, means value for SI and SPA are positive and show favorable attitude. Whereas, SPB has fairly low mean value, this indicates that the purchase behavior is still less likely. The standard deviation values seem reasonable as well. Altogether, it can be concluded from these descriptive statistics that rather favorable response towards sustainable literacy, social influence, purchase attitude was observed, whereas sustainable purchase behavior received relatively weak responses from the respondents.

### **Scree plot**

A scree plot is a type of graph used in factor analysis to plot the factor eigenvalues in descending order. It can be used as a tool to decide the number of “factors” by pinpointing where the curve tends to level off, or become somewhat horizontal. The “elbow” is where the line appears to start flattening. (Raymond B. Cattell, 1966)

**Fig. 12: Scree Plot**



**Source:** Created by Researcher using SPSS Software

The scree plot suggested that a large, dominant first factor existed within the dataset and that the eigenvalues drastically declined after the first factor. This indicates that there are some significant underlying shared variances among items. However, the scree plot in itself does not demonstrate that there are five constructs distinct from one another.

For this reason, interpretation of factor structure was guided both by theory and by factor loadings.

The five constructs were retained to theoretically distinct from one another; the large dominant first factor in the scree plot is accepted as empirical limitation of the measuring structure.

A “p-value” (significance value) is a measure which can be taken to interpret how strong the evidence is against the “null hypothesis”. The chance of achieving a result is known as the p-value. such as those that were observed, given the “null hypothesis” is absolute. Therefore, a small “p-value” would suggest good evidence in favor of rejecting the null hypothesis. In social

research, generally, a “p-value”  $< 0.05$  is used as statistically significant and is accepted as indication that a relationship is meaningful. (Joseph F. Hair Jr. et al., 2010)

T-statistics, or t-value, is a statistical measure used to decide a relationship between variables is “statistically significant”. It represents the ratio of the estimated effect to its standard error, indicating how strongly a variable influences another. A higher t-value suggests stronger evidence against the “null hypothesis”. In general, a t-value above 1.96 (at 5% sig. level) is considered “statistically significant”. T-statistics is widely used in hypothesis testing to support decision-making regarding acceptance or rejection of hypotheses. (Joseph F. Hair Jr. et al., 2010)

### **Hypotheses Testing**

Hypothesis testing is the statistical process to support or deny a given hypothesis with sufficient evidence. This process entails the observation of the sample data, which are evaluated for variable correlation. A conclusion is reached through significant values. This enables the validation of the research assumptions with a coherent approach. (Joseph F. Hair Jr. et al., 2010)

**Fig.13: Hypotheses Testing**

| Hypotheses | Hypothesized Relationship | P Value | T-Statistics | Decision |
|------------|---------------------------|---------|--------------|----------|
| <b>H1</b>  | SL → SPA                  | 0.01    | 3.729        | ✓ Accept |
| <b>H2</b>  | SI → SPA                  | 0.001   | 3.655        | ✓ Accept |
| <b>H3</b>  | SPA → SPB                 | 0.082   | 1.827        | ✗ Reject |
| <b>H4</b>  | SPB → SLS                 | 0.333   | 0.987        | ✗ Reject |

**Source:** Created by Researcher using SPSS Software

The results of “hypothesis testing” reveal that “H1 and H2” are supported, while “H3 and H4” are not supported. Specifically, Sustainable Literacy (SL) has a “significant positive impact” on Sustainable Purchase Attitude (SPA) ( $p = 0.01$ ), and Social Influence (SI) also significantly influences SPA ( $p = 0.001$ ), as both “p-values” are less than 0.05. However, the relationship between “Sustainable Purchase Attitude” (SPA) and “Sustainable Purchase Behavior” (SPB) is not significant ( $p = 0.082$ ), H3 was not supported. Perhaps this may indicate that having a

positive sustainable purchasing attitude alone, although important, cannot always lead to actual sustainable purchasing behavior. Sustainable purchasing behavior may be affected by other factors such as price, availability and convenience of sustainable products. Therefore, a positive attitude may not always be converted into actual purchasing behavior. Similarly, the relationship between SPB and Sustainable Lifestyle (SLS) is also insignificant ( $p = 0.333$ ), H4 was not supported. The non-significant relationship may suggest that sustainable purchasing behavior alone may not be sufficient to establish a broader sustainable lifestyle. Sustainable lifestyle includes regular daily practices such as waste reduction, energy conservation and other long-term sustainable habits. Therefore, sustainable lifestyle may also depend on other personal, social and practical factors beyond purchasing behavior. These findings indicate that although awareness and social factors positively influence attitudes, these attitudes may not always translate into “actual behavior and lifestyle changes” among respondents.

## **CONCLUSION OF THE STUDY**

This study examined the perception of Generation Z towards sustainable consumption and lifestyle choices in India by analyzing the role of sustainable literacy, social influence, purchase attitude, and purchase behavior. The discoveries reveal that Generation Z possesses generally positive responses towards sustainability. Sustainable literacy and social influence were found to have a profound effect on “sustainable purchase attitude”, indicating that knowledge and peer influence take part in a crucial role in forming favorable perceptions towards eco-friendly practices.

However, the results show that there exists an attitude-behavior gap; a favorable attitude towards purchasing the green products did not yield a statistically significant intention for making those green purchases. Despite having positive attitudes, Generation Z does not consistently translate these attitudes into sustainable purchase behavior. Furthermore, sustainable purchase behavior was not found to significantly influence sustainable lifestyle choices, suggesting that behavioral change is limited and influenced by practical constraints such as cost, convenience, and accessibility of sustainable products.

Overall, the study come to an end that while awareness and attitudes towards sustainability are strong among Generation Z, there is a need to bridge “the discrepancy between behavior and intention”. Efforts from policymakers, businesses, and educators are essential to promote sustainable practices by making “eco-friendly” options easier to reach, affordable, and convenient. This will help in encouraging long-term behavioral change and the adoption of sustainable lifestyles admist India’s youthful customers.

## **IMPLICATIONS OF THE STUDY**

Based on the result of this study, several key implications were drawn for policy makers, firms and academics. First of all, as sustainable literacy and social influence exert strong effects on purchase attitude, government and firms should promote their awareness campaigns and education programmers so as to improve knowledge about environmental issues and eco-friendly attitudes among Gen Z consumers. Second, a gap b/w purchase attitudes and “purchase behavior” has appeared which leads business firms should concentrate on improvement of the affordability, accessibility and availability of sustainable goods and service. Firm should also improve transparency of its sustainable claims in order to enhance consumers’ trusts on their sustainable efforts. Third, purchase behavior is found not significantly correlated to sustainable lifestyle which suggests that awareness alone can’t lead to behavior change. Policy makers should implement supporting policies, incentive schemes and infrastructures to assist consumers in choosing sustainable consumption as an easy and practical option. Lastly, this study adds value in research by suggesting an investigation in both cognitive and practical attributes affecting sustainable consumption and provides reference to explore further variables which will contribute in attitude-behavior gap in future.

## **FUTURE RESEARCH DIRECTIONS**

There are many interesting and important directions this study may point for upcoming studies on sustainable consumption practices among “Gen Z” respondents. First, future studies may increase sample size of respondents from various regions of India, to make the results more generalized. There may be interesting differences in behavior if conducted between urban and rural inhabitants.

Second, to answer the question “attitude behavior gap”, future studies may involve various additional variables such as price sensitivity, environmental concern, government policies, technological factors etc. which can contribute towards sustainable behavior.

Third, in order to examine how sustainable behavior changes over time with growing concern towards environment it can be studied longitudinally. This study can then help in giving dynamic picture of consumption.

Finally, studies may be carried out to observe the Effects of internet and Digital media on the sustainable consumption behavior among Generation Z.

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